

VMware Workstation Installation Issue

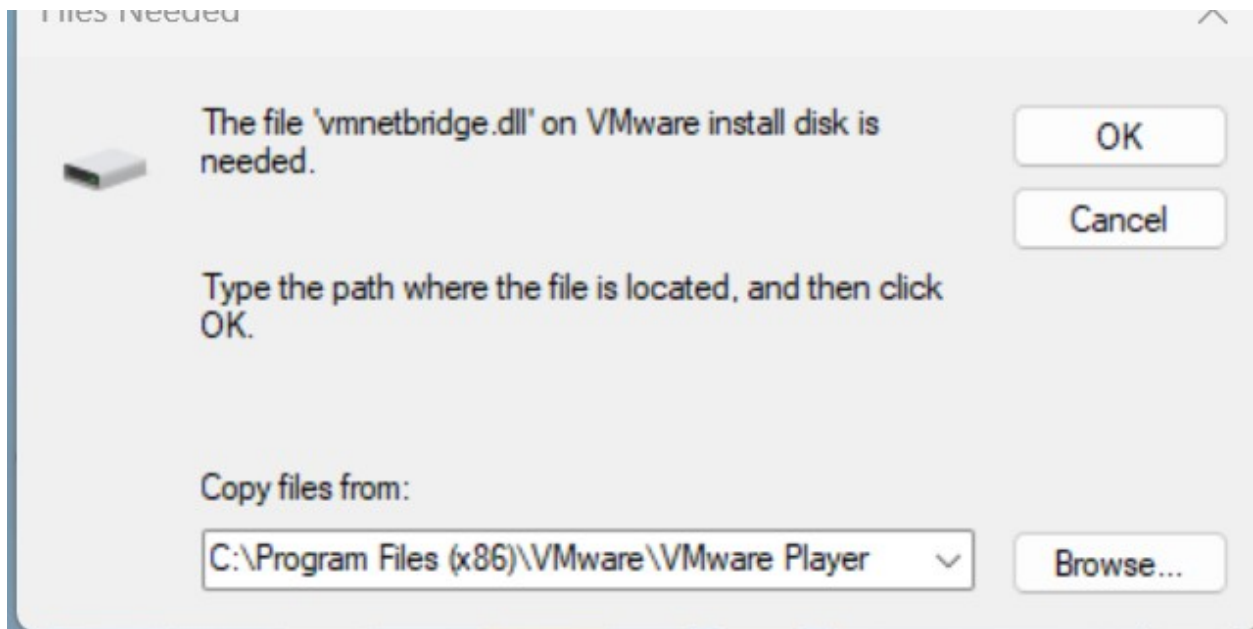
Problem Statement

During installation of **VMware Workstation** on Windows, the installer shows an error message:

"The file vmnetbridge.dll on VMware install disk is needed."

The installation pauses and asks the user to browse and provide the file path manually.

If vmnetbridge.dll is missing, the correct solution is to repair or reinstall VMware Workstation so the bridge network driver is restored properly.



The above screenshot shows the exact error popup requesting the vmnetbridge.dll file path. This helps in identifying the issue quickly during installation.

Cause of the Problem

This issue occurs mainly due to:

- Previously installed **VMware Player** or **older VMware Workstation**
- Incomplete or improper uninstallation of VMware
- Existing VMware network drivers not auto-detected by Windows

As a result, Windows cannot automatically locate the required network file.

About vmnetbridge.dll

vmnetbridge.dll is a **VMware network driver file** required for:

- Bridged networking
- Allowing virtual machines to connect to the same network as the host

It is a critical component for VMware networking.

Solution / Steps to Fix

1. When the popup appears, click **Browse**
2. Navigate to one of the following paths:
3. C:\Program Files (x86)\VMware\VMware Workstation

or

C:\Program Files (x86)\VMware\VMware Player

4. Select the file **vmnetbridge.dll**
5. Click **Open** → **OK**

The installation will continue successfully.

Why This Solution Works

The required file already exists on the system from a previous VMware installation. The installer only needs the correct file path to proceed.

ALSO, The **#service network restart** was failing because VMware's bridged network driver (vmnetbridge.dll) was missing. Fixing the VMware bridge driver restored VM network connectivity and resolved the issue.

Conclusion - This is not a critical error but a common installation issue caused by existing VMware components. Providing the correct file path resolves the problem immediately.

Browsing works only when the file exists.

If the file is missing, only Repair or Clean Reinstall is the correct fix.

